

If the Self Alone Liberates, Why the Guru?
From Guru to the Inner Guru — The Mind Turning Toward the Self

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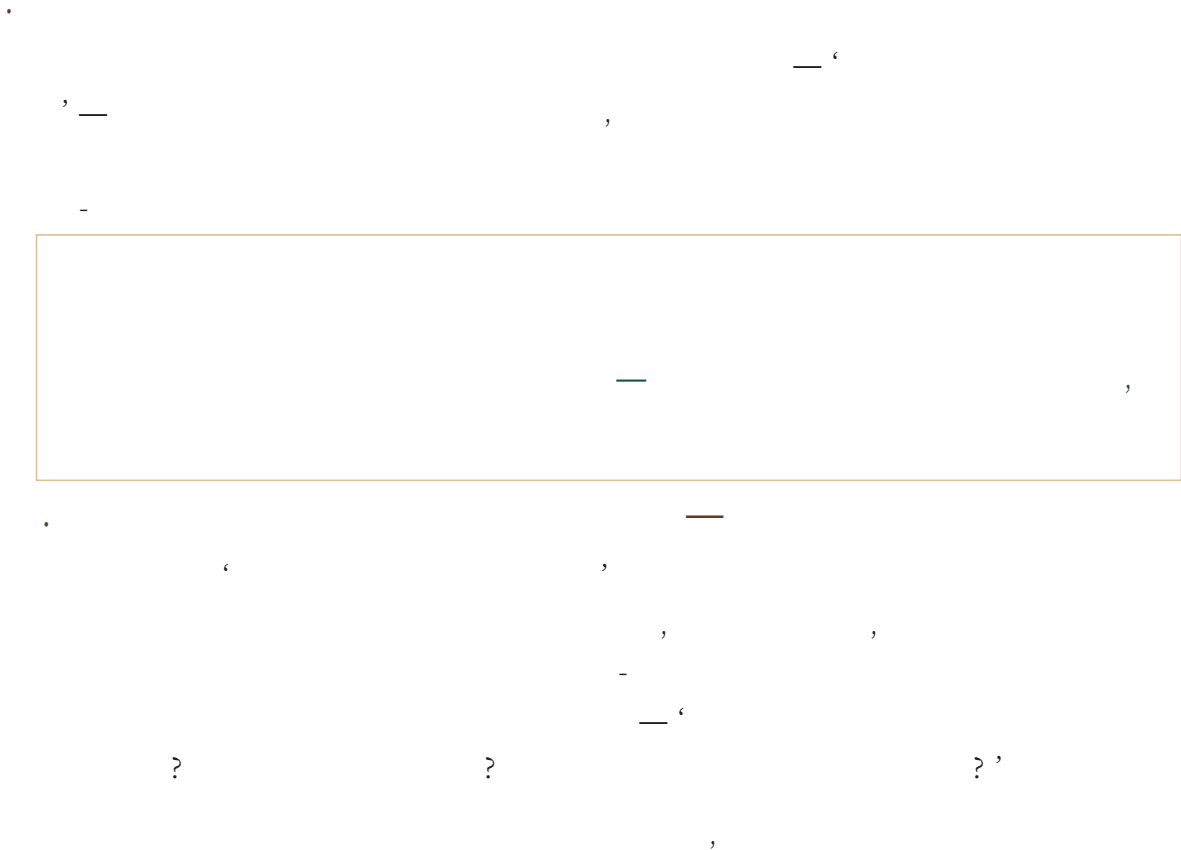
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English Contemplation — The Teacher Who Returns You to Yourself

The Guru does not possess a Self that the disciple lacks. The Guru's gift is subtler: a corrected vision. The teacher points out that what we seek as an object is the very light by which every object is known.

At first, the teaching seems to come from outside. We listen, question, reflect and struggle. Gradually, the borrowed words become assimilated understanding. The outer teacher has not disappeared; the teacher's work has flowered within.

The highest function of the Guru is therefore not to create permanent dependence, but to turn the mind toward the ever-present Self. The finger is revered because it points to the moon; its purpose is fulfilled when the moon is seen.

